

# NovaTech Code of Business Conduct and Ethics

*NovaTech Solutions Inc. — Internal Human Resources Policy Document [FICTIONAL SAMPLE]*

## 1. Ethical Foundations

NovaTech Solutions holds all employees, contractors, and executives to the highest standards of professional honesty, fairness, and mutual respect in all business interactions.

## 2. Anti-Harassment and Non-Discrimination

NovaTech strictly prohibits verbal, physical, sexual, or visual harassment. Any behavior creating an intimidating, hostile, or offensive working environment will result in immediate disciplinary intervention.

## 3. Conflict of Interest and Confidentiality

Employees must not engage in outside business activities or secondary employment that competes with NovaTech or impairs their professional judgment. Proprietary source code, customer records, and trade secrets must remain confidential at all times.

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### **4. Disciplinary Consequences for Policy Violations**

What happens if an employee violates the company's code of conduct? Any reported violation is thoroughly investigated by the Ethics & Compliance Committee within ten (10) business days. Depending upon the gravity and intent of the infraction, NovaTech enforces progressive disciplinary actions: (a) First minor infraction: formal written warning and mandatory compliance counseling; (b) Second or repeated infraction: suspension without pay for up to fourteen (14) calendar days; (c) Serious violations—including theft, workplace violence, sexual harassment, fraud, or intentional breach of client confidentiality—result in immediate summary termination of employment for cause and potential legal referral.

### **5. Whistleblower Protection and Reporting Channels**

NovaTech guarantees strict confidentiality and zero retaliation for any employee who reports suspected ethical or legal misconduct in good faith via the anonymous Ethics Hotline.